2002 Toyota Camry LE

$2,900 · 254,654 miles · Private seller · Mountain Mesa (Lake Isabella), CA

Seller: Private seller

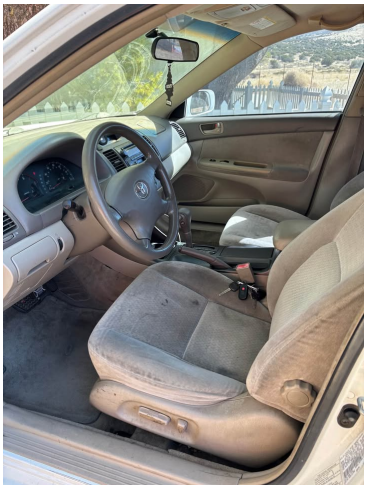
Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/4848146008750118/

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 1 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$3,342	**$482**	**Below average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	2/5 · 4 recalls · 1,043 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$2,900.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$268.25
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$18.85
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$3,342.10
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$3,342.10
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$3,492.10

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 24 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$197.92
Maintenance & repair reserve	$200.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.07
Total per month	$481.99

Running costs without the loan: **$482/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$9,276** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Below average (2/5)

The 2002 Camry 2.4 (2AZ-FE) is a tough car, but at 254k anything can go. Fresh tires, shocks, belts, smog and registration make it a fair cheap in-town car. Not ideal for heavy DoorDash miles.

NHTSA data for this model year: 4 recalls · 1,043 owner complaints (275 involving a crash). Most complaints: Vehicle Speed Control (295), Service Brakes (185), Hydraulic (156), Engine And Engine Cooling (112), Air Bags (102), Power Train (77).

Known issues for this model

• 2AZ-FE oil burning (piston rings) common at high miles

• Two pending codes not explained (often EVAP or catalyst)

• 254k mi: transmission, mounts, and AC are wear items

Check on this car before buying

• Have the pending codes read before buying

• Check oil level and look for blue smoke

• Test the transmission shifts and the AC

• Look for leaks at the valve cover and power steering

Notes

Added 2026-10-30 as an in-town ~$3k option. Listed 10/29, OBO. 254k mi, clean title in the seller's name, 2 owners, smog just passed, registration paid to 2027. New tires, shocks and belts; new brakes and rotors come in the box. Two pending engine codes. About 1 hour away via CA-178. Ask what the two codes are.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.